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GREGG WALLACE: SEX PEST CLAIMS LEFT ME SUICIDAL

Scandal-hit presenter insists he never meant to upset anyone

GREGG Wallace has revealed he was left suicidal after a string of claims that he behaved inappropriately on MasterChef.

He admitted making 'smutty' jokes in the past and said he 'must have offended a lot of people over the years' – but insisted he had not groped, bullied or harassed production staff.

In his first interview since his career imploded, Wallace, 60, said he regretted ever agreeing to host the BBC cooking show, describing it as 'signing a pact with the Devil'.

He told the Daily Mail's Rebecca Hardy: 'It's very diffi-

By **Grant Tucker**
Entertainment Editor

cult to explain the pressure unless you've been through it. 'I thought about suicide all the time – "Is my insurance up to date? Will [wife] Anna get some money? She doesn't deserve this. It would be better if I wasn't here".'

Wallace, a former grocer, stood back from presenting MasterChef in November after 13 complainants, including former Newsnight presenter Kirsty Wark, accused him of misconduct.

In the interview, he described being overwhelmed as the number of claims rose to 30 over the following days, including accusations from Vanessa



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In the eye of a storm: Former MasterChef presenter Gregg Wallace with wife Anna